

Second Hong Kong Linguistics Olympiad
14 June 2020
Individual Contest Problems

Rules for writing out the solutions

Do not copy the statements of the problems. Write down your solution to each problem on the answer booklet. Unless stated differently, you should describe any patterns or rules that you identified in the data, otherwise your solution will not be awarded full marks.

Problem 1 (25 points). Ainu

Given below are some sentences in the Shizunai dialect of Ainu¹ and their translations into English.

1.	korpa as wa isam	We have had.
2.	inkartek an wa an	I was glancing.
3.	e inkar wa an	You (sg) were seeing.
4.	inu wa isam	He has listened.
5.	iperepa wa oka	They were feeding.
6.	e ipe wa an	You (sg) were eating.
7.	eci inuruywa wa oka	You (pl) were listening a lot.
8.	cie koretek wa isam	We have lent you (sg).
9.	cieci nukarruywa wa isam	We have stared at you (pl).
10.	eun nurepa wa oka	You (sg) were telling us.
11.	un etekpa wa oka	He was tasting us.
12.	ecien nutek wa an	You (pl) were listening to me a little.
13.	an yaynu wa isam	I have thought.
14.	an eruypa wa oka	I was devouring them.
15.	inuruywa as wa isam	We have listened a lot.
16.	en e wa an	They were eating me.
17.	e yaykore wa isam.	You (sg) have given yourself (sg).
18.	cieci nurepa wa oka.	We were telling you (pl).

(a) Translate into English. If you think that there are multiple possible translations, write them all:

19.	e nukarepa wa isam	21.	e koreruy wa an
20.	ci yaynukarpa wa oka	22.	nuruywa wa isam

(b) Translate into Ainu:

23.	He was listening to you (pl).	26.	We have eaten.
24.	You (sg) were thinking a lot.	27.	They were staring.
25.	We were borrowing him.	28.	I have glanced at them.

—James Britton, Vlad A. Neacșu

¹ Ainu is an indigenous language of Japan that is unrelated to Japanese. It is now almost extinct, but was previously spoken by the Ainu people around the northern island of Hokkaido up until the last century.